Lennard Alexander Welslau

PhD Fellow, University of Copenhagen and Danmarks Nationalbank

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Education

University of Copenhagen

PhD Economics since 09/2024

– Advisor: Søren Hove Ravn

– PhD-level courses in economic theory, macroeconometrics, microeconometrics, dynamic programming, economic growth, business cycles, heterogeneous agent models

MSc Economics 09/2019–09/2022

– Thesis: Wage Flexibility and Household Heterogeneity in a Small Open Economy; grade 12 (highest)

– Courses in advanced microeconomics, macroeconomics, and econometrics, international political economy, public finance; GPA: 10.8 (top decile)

New York University, *Visiting PhD Student* 09/2026–01/2027

Department of Economics; host: Simon Gilchrist

– Course in Empirical Monetary and Macroeconomics; macroeconomics reading group

University College Freiburg, *BA Liberal Arts and Sciences* 10/2014–08/2018

– Thesis: An Application of Lakatosian Methodology to Finance Theory; grade 1.0 (highest)

– Courses include economic theory, statistics, mathematics, philosophy of science, political theory, comparative politics, international relations, and international law; GPA: 1.5 (excellent)

– Exchange semester, University of Buenos Aires (2017); Summer School, Harvard University (2016)

Research

Work in progress

Bank Credit Supply and Entrepreneurship, with Tobias Renkin and Filip Rozsypal

We study how bank credit supply at founding affects firm entry and performance. We match credit supply shocks at Danish banks to potential entrepreneurs through their pre-existing personal banking relationship. A one standard deviation increase in credit supply raises the rate at which individuals start firms by 3%. Firms founded under higher credit supply end up significantly larger one decade after entry.

Publications

Sovereign Debt and Fiscal Integration in the European Union, with Zsolt Darvas and Jeromin Zettelmeyer (2025), *Journal of Economic Perspectives*

Demographic change will hit public debt sustainability in European Union countries, with Zsolt Darvas and Jeromin Zettelmeyer (2025), *Journal of Policy Modeling*

Export competition between China and Latin America and the Caribbean in the United States market, with Raquel Artecona and Daniel E. Perrotti (2024), *The World Economy*

Revise and resubmit

What will it take to stabilise public debt in advanced countries?, with Zsolt Darvas, Gonzalo Huertas and Jeromin Zettelmeyer (2026), *IMF Economic Review*

Selected policy work

Quantifying the Sensitivity of EU Debt Sustainability Analysis, working paper (2026)

What Germany's medium-term fiscal plan means for Europe, with Zsolt Darvas and Jeromin Zettelmeyer (2025), Bruegel Policy Brief

The longer-term fiscal challenges facing the European Union, with Jeromin Zettelmeyer, Grégory Claeys, Zsolt Darvas and Stavros Zenios (2024), in *A Yearbook on the Euro 2024*

Distributional Effects of Climate Policy, with Juan Mejino López and Georg Zachmann, in *Handbook on the Welfare State and Climate Change*, forthcoming

Presentations

2026: NYU Student Macro Lunch; Danmarks Nationalbank Research Brownbag; University of Copenhagen Internal Macro Seminar

2024: European Parliament Committee on Budgets (BUDG); FEPS and Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung expert meeting; Danish Graduate Programme in Economics (DGPE) Conference; Bruegel Research Seminar

2023: German Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (BMZ); Bruegel Research Seminar

2022: Bruegel Research Seminar

Professional Experience

Danmarks Nationalbank, *Resident PhD Fellow* since 09/2024

Research unit; firm dynamics, financial frictions, heterogeneous agent models

European Macro Policy Network (EMPN), *Policy Fellow* since 09/2024

Advised on debt sustainability and potential output modelling; co-authored policy brief on fiscal space

Bruegel

Research Contractor 09/2024–09/2025

German and European fiscal policy, debt sustainability, EU fiscal integration

Research Analyst 10/2022–09/2024

Developed Bruegel's debt sustainability analysis model and inflation inequality tracker; research on EU economic governance, sovereign debt, trade, and inequality; co-authored work presented at IMF, ECB, Informal ECOFIN

United Nations ECLAC

Economic Affairs Consultant 06/2021–01/2022

Structural gravity models, export competition, US–China trade tensions

Carlo Schmid Fellow 09/2020–04/2021

Trade data analysis; US trade and development policy

European Central Bank, *Trainee* 09/2018–03/2019

Directorate General Market Infrastructure and Payments

Student research assistant positions

Copenhagen Business School (2020–2021); University of Freiburg, Chair of Economic Policy (2018)

Other

Refereeing

Public Finance Review; International Economics and Economic Policy

Awards and grants

Full PhD scholarship, Danmarks Nationalbank; Bikuben Foundation Fellow; William Demant Foundation grant; UCPH International scholarship; Carlo Schmid scholarship (DAAD, German Academic Scholarship Foundation); DAAD scholarship

Skills

– Programming: Python, Stata (advanced); R, Julia, Matlab, SQL, Git
– Data: Danish administrative registers (firm, bank, household, and customs microdata); international trade data
– Languages: German (native); English, Spanish (fluent); Danish, French (basic)